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This disease strategy manual is an integral part of the Australian Aquatic Veterinary Emergency Plan (AQUAVETPLAN).

The manual sets out the disease control principles for use in response to a suspected or confirmed incursion of viral haemorrhagic septicaemia virus in Australia.

Viral haemorrhagic septicaemia virus has been isolated from approximately 80 different fish species throughout the Northern Hemisphere, including North America, Asia and Europe. It causes fish kills in wild fish and high mortality in affected farmed fish.



Gizzard shad from North America infected with VHS.

Photo courtesy of Dr. Mohamed Faisal, Michigan State University.

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